



WEEK FOUR · MODULE THREE

The Anticipation Drill

Where the method stops being a theory

THE PRIVATE CONCIERGE ACADEMY

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HOW TO STUDY THIS MODULE

This module is worked, not read. Nothing here can be learned by understanding it.

The scenarios have no perfect answers, and several of them have a trap. Write your answer before you read the debrief, always.

Total time, honestly: about four hours across the week.

CHAPTER I

How this week is practised

Four exercises, in order

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

Understand what each exercise is training, and why the order matters.

Exercise	What it trains, and how long it takes
1 · The observation log	Structured attention. Ten minutes a night, seven nights. This is the foundation and everything else is built on it.
2 · The question count	Awareness of how often you outsource your own preparation. One day, no extra time, considerable discomfort.
3 · Twelve scenarios	Judgement under ambiguity, including knowing when not to act. About two hours.
4 · The pre-mortem	Structured pessimism. Twenty minutes on something real in your own life.

CHAPTER II

Exercise one

The observation log, seven days

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

Practise structured observation on a real environment.

Produce evidence, not impressions.

Choose one environment you are in every day. Your household. A workplace. A family you know. It does not need to be a wealthy one, and it is better if it is not, because the discipline is what is being trained, not the context.

Every evening, ten minutes, in writing, in the six categories. **Facts only.** If a sentence contains the words "seemed", "felt", "probably" or "I think", it is not an observation and it does not belong in the log.

Category	What you write
Preference	One line. Something someone likes, precisely, not approximately.
Pattern	Something that has now happened more than twice at the same time or in the same way.
Threshold	Something that was tolerated, and something that was not.
Aversion	Something nobody said aloud and everyone worked around.
Rhythm	When this person or this house is approachable, and when they are not.
Anomaly	Anything today that departed from the pattern.

WHAT YOU WILL FIND

Days one to three are empty and it will feel like a waste of time.

Around day four the log starts to fill on its own, because you have begun to see differently during the day rather than remembering at night. That shift is the entire purpose of the exercise, and it cannot be reached by reading about it.

Submit: the seven days, as written. Not tidied. Not improved afterwards.

CHAPTER III

Exercise two

The question count

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

Measure how often you outsource your own preparation.

For one full day, count every question you asked someone that **better preparation on your part would have answered**. Not questions of consent, not questions about irreversible things, not questions about money. Only the ones where you were, in truth, asking someone else to do your thinking.

Write the number down. Write down the three worst ones, in full.

Then, for each of the three, write the single thing you could have done the day before that would have made the question unnecessary. **That list is the beginning of your playbook.**

CHAPTER IV

Twelve scenarios

Answer each before reading the debrief

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

Apply the loop under ambiguity.

Recognise the scenarios in which the correct action is no action at all.

For each: what do you do, what do you say, and what do you deliberately not do. Two or three sentences. Then read the debrief.

1 · The rain

It is 07:40. The principal leaves on foot at 08:00, as she does every day. It has begun to rain and it was not forecast.

2 · The airline

You learn at 21:00 that tomorrow morning's flight, on which the principal is due at a board meeting in Geneva at 09:00, has a high probability of being cancelled. It has not been cancelled yet.

3 · The anniversary

You realise, from a photograph in the hall, that next Tuesday is the principal's wedding anniversary. Nobody has mentioned it. Nothing is in the calendar.

4 · The quiet child

The younger child, twelve, has been silent at breakfast for four days. He has always been talkative. Nobody else appears to have noticed.

5 · The friend

The principal's closest friend telephones the house and asks, warmly and without any apparent motive, whether the family are still going to Sardinia in August.

6 · The supplier

The contractor on the London renovation has said "next week" three times. You are now certain the date will be missed by a month. The principal believes it is on schedule.

7 · The second bottle

At a private dinner, the principal opens a second bottle of a wine that you know, from the cellar book, is the last of its case and was described to you as irreplaceable.

8 · The upgrade

A hotel offers, at no cost, to move the family to a better suite. It is objectively better. The family have stayed in the same suite for six years.

9 · The message

The principal says, in passing and while looking at his telephone, "tell Mark I will call him". You do not know which Mark, and there are two.

10 · The empty diary

Thursday afternoon, normally the busiest of the week, is entirely empty in the calendar, and has been cleared without explanation.

11 · The other principal

The principal's wife asks you, pleasantly, what time her husband got back last night. You know.

12 · The four hundred euros

A delivery arrives with the wrong item. The correct one can be couriered today for four hundred euros, or arrive free in six days. The threshold in this house is five hundred. It is the child's birthday gift, and the birthday is tomorrow.

CHAPTER V

The debriefs

Read only after you have written all twelve

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

Compare your judgement to the professional standard.

1 · The rain

The umbrella is by the door. Nothing is said. You do not ask whether she would like one, because asking hands her a decision at 07:55 on a morning she has already planned. If she walks past it, that is information, and it goes in the file. This is the simplest scenario in the set and it is the one that most people over-complicate by speaking.

2 · The airline

Anticipate and inform, in that order. You hold the alternative: the earlier flight, the private option with the price, the train, whichever is real. Then, that evening, one sentence: "There is a risk on the 07:10. I have you held on the 05:50 and the car adjusted." You do not present a problem, you present a resolved problem. And you do inform, because the alternative involves his time and his money, and those are always his.

3 · The anniversary

You do nothing, and you say nothing, and this is the trap in the set. It is not your anniversary to manage. You are not their marriage. What you may legitimately do is make sure that the day is not sabotaged by the household: no dinner scheduled, no contractor in the house, the diary quietly kept clear if you have the authority to do so. That is service. Flowers on their behalf, a booking they did not ask for, a card: that is presumption, and it is the servile drift.

4 · The quiet child

You observe, you record it factually, and you make certain the person whose responsibility it is has the chance to see what you saw. You do not investigate. You do not ask him what is wrong. You do not become the adult he confides in, however kind that instinct is,

because that is the confidante trap in its most seductive form. The correct action is small, boring, and correct: a factual line, to the right person, once.

5 · The friend

"I am not able to help with that, but I will let them know you called." Warm, complete, final. Movement information does not travel to friends, and the fact that they are close is not evidence, it is the reason the question is dangerous. You then tell the principal, without drama, that the question was asked. That last part is what separates a professional from someone who simply refused politely.

6 · The supplier

Escalate today, and escalate correctly. Not "there may be a delay". You bring: the revised date, the reason in one sentence, the cost, and two options. The error people make here is waiting for certainty. You already have certainty, and every day you sit on it converts a supplier's failure into your own concealment.

7 · The second bottle

You say nothing and you pour it. It is his wine. This is the boundary of anticipation in its purest form: you may prepare, you may prevent friction, you may not manage his choices. What you do is note it, and replace what can be replaced, and tell the cellar. The staff member who says "sir, this is the last one" has just made himself the guardian of a grown man's decisions in front of his guests.

8 · The upgrade

You decline it, politely, and you do not mention it. Six years in the same suite is not an accident, it is a preference, and a preference of that depth outranks any objective improvement. If you are uncertain, you hold both and say nothing. The rule underneath this one is large: **better is not a reason. Evidence is a reason.**

9 · The message

You ask. Immediately, in the same breath, before he has looked back at his telephone. "Mark Denison, or Mark at the office?" One second, no friction, done. This is the scenario that tests whether you have understood the module or merely enjoyed it: guessing between two Marks is not anticipation, it is a coin toss with your career on it. Anticipation is built on evidence, and you have none.

10 · The empty diary

You do nothing, you ask nothing, and you protect it absolutely. You do not fill it, you do not enquire, you do not let anyone else book into it, and you do not speculate, to anyone, ever, about why it is empty. A cleared afternoon is one of the most confidential objects in a household.

11 · The other principal

"I am not sure of the exact time." And then nothing else, and no elaboration, and no expression, and you do not look away. This is Week 3 arriving in the middle of Week 4, and it will arrive exactly like this: warmly, from someone with every right to ask, about something trivial. You do not carry information between principals, in either direction, ever. You will feel dishonest. You are not being dishonest, you are being a professional, and the day you carry one sentence between them you have become a channel and channels are removed.

12 · The four hundred euros

You ask, and you ask in a way that costs one second of attention: "The gift will not arrive in time. Four hundred to have it tomorrow, or it is six days. Shall I?" You have prepared everything, you have decided nothing. This is the model answer for the entire week. It is under the threshold, it is obviously the right call, you are certainly correct, and it is still not your decision, because it is their child and their money. Perfect preparation, presented as a one-second decision, is the highest form of this craft.

CHAPTER VI

Exercise four

*The pre-mortem***LEARNING OBJECTIVES**

Run a real pre-mortem, and then check it against reality.

Choose something real that is happening in your own life in the next fourteen days. A journey, a dinner, a meeting, a move.

Twenty minutes. Assume it has failed. Write down what the failure was, in the past tense, with specificity. Then for each failure, write the single-point-of-failure, the unchecked assumption, or the handover that caused it. Then write the second option.

Afterwards, when it has happened, compare. **Submit both: the pre-mortem, and one paragraph on what actually went wrong and whether you had seen it.** That second paragraph is worth more than the first.

CHAPTER VII

Marking scheme

What I am looking for

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

Know exactly how this week is assessed.

Criterion	What earns it
Evidence, not invention	Every anticipated action traces back to something you observed. If I cannot find the evidence in your answer, it is a guess, however elegant.
Knowing when not to act	Scenarios 3, 4, 7, 8, 10 and 11 are all restraint. If you acted in most of them, you have not understood the week, and that is a common and correctable failure.
Knowing when to ask	Scenarios 9 and 12 are questions, not anticipations. Getting these wrong is more serious than getting the others wrong.
The withdrawal	No narration, no "I took the liberty", no hovering. I will read your phrasing closely for this.
The log	Seven days, factual, unedited. This is the piece I will weigh most heavily, because it is the one you cannot fake in an evening.

HOW TO SUBMIT, AND HOW TO BOOK YOUR SESSION

- 1. Submit.** Everything you produced this week goes into the **Submit** area of **Module 4**, inside your student portal. One PDF. Not by email, and not in the chat.
- 2. Book.** The moment your work is uploaded, a **Book your session** button appears in that same place. Click it and choose your slot with me. Do it straight away, while you are there, because the slots for each week are limited and they are taken in the order they are booked.
- 3. Leave me time.** Book your session for at least **two days after your submission**, so that I can read your work properly beforehand. That way the session is spent on the correction rather than on the reading, and you get every minute of it.

The work from this module is submitted together with your deliverable, in a single PDF.

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